METRIC

A-A-20283
January 8, 1999

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SOUP MIX, VEGETABLE, DEHYDRATED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers dehydrated vegetable soup mix, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be of the following types, classes, and optional ingredients as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types, classes, and optional ingredients.

Type I - With added monosodium glutamate
Type II - Without added monosodium glutamate

Class 1 - Individual servings: Envelopes, 9.9 g (0.35 ounces) containing 2/4.96 g (2/0.175 ounce) envelopes per carton
Class 2 - Individual servings: Cups, 45.4 g to 63.8 g (1.6 ounces to 2.25 ounces)
Class 3 - Family servings: 51 g (1.8 ounces) carton containing 2/25.5 g (2/0.9 ounce) envelopes per carton
Class 4 - Bulk servings: 1.22 kg (2.7 pounds) per container
Class 5 - Other

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8935

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Optional ingredients A - With other ingredients, such as, but no limited to; starches, food colorings, wheat gluten, soy products, acidulent sweeteners, barley/grains, or vegetable oil.
Optional ingredients B - Without other ingredients.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Processing: The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be prepared in accordance with good manufacturing practice.

3.2 Raw vegetables: The dehydrated vegetables and soup base shall be prepared from properly matured, wholesome, clean vegetables.

3.2.1 Age requirement: The vegetables used in the preparation of this product shall be prepared from the latest season's crop. Product shall be processed and packaged less than one year prior to purchase, by the purchaser.

3.3 DEHYDRATED PRODUCT:

3.3.1 Ingredients: The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall contain carrots and other vegetables, such as, but not limited to; cabbage, onions and/or leeks, diced potatoes and/or peas, red and/or green bell peppers, and tomatoes. When Type II dehydrated vegetable soup mix is specified, natural flavorings and spices shall be used.

3.3.2 Flavor and odor: The dehydrated vegetables shall have appropriate characteristic flavors and odors. There shall be no foreign flavors and odors such as, but not limited to; burnt, scorched, stale, rancid, musty, or moldy.

3.3.3 Color: The color shall be reasonably bright and not dull. The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall possess reasonably good color.

3.3.4 Consistency: The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be a uniformly blended, free flowing mixture.

3.3.5 Flavoring ingredients: Only natural vegetable flavorings and spices shall be used. Chicken, beef, or other animal-based broth products are not allowed.

3.3.6 Monosodium glutamate content: When Type II, dehydrated vegetable soup mix, is specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, there shall be no added monosodium glutamate. Note: Natural occurring monosodium glutamate in vegetable soup mix is generally insignificant.

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3.3.7 Defects: The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be reasonably free from defects which detract from the appearance, such as, but not limited to; peel, blemished units, discoloration, and extraneous vegetable material. Defective units shall not exceed 16 percent by weight of all vegetable material based on the average of samples inspected.

3.4 REHYDRATED PRODUCT:

3.4.1 Flavor and odor: The rehydrated vegetable soup mix shall have a good flavor and odor typical of vegetable soup. The rehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be free from objectionable odors; such as, but not limited to; burnt, scorched, or stale. Vegetables will rehydrate evenly and be practically free from chewy or tough pieces when cooked.

3.4.2 Color: The rehydrated vegetable soup mix shall have a uniformly bright and good color with no appearance of a grey or dark cast.

3.4.3 Defects: The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be practically free from any defects that materially affect the edibility of the product, such as, but not limited to; burnt, scorched, and decay.

3.4.4 Texture: The vegetables shall adequately rehydrate. Vegetable units shall not be chewy, hard, or mushy.

3.5 Foreign material: The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be free of foreign material such as dirt, rodent, and insect infestation.

3.6 Analytical requirements: Unless otherwise specified, analytical requirements for the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be as follows:

3.6.1 Moisture content: The moisture content of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 8.0 percent.

3.6.2 Salt content: The salt content of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall range between 1.5 to 8.0 percent per serving.

3.6.3 Fat content: The fat content of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 5.0 percent.

3.6.4 Standard plate count: The total for the standard plate count of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 250,000 per gram.

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3.6.5 Reduced sulfite *Anaerobic Clostridium*: The reduced sulfite *Anaerobic Clostridium* of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 10 colony forming units (CFU) maximum per gram.

3.6.6 Yeast and mold: The yeast and mold count of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 500 CFU per gram.

3.6.7 *Coliform*: The *coliform* count of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 100 CFU per gram.

3.6.8 *E. coli*: The *E. coli* count of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall not exceed 0.10 CFU per gram.

3.6.9 *Salmonella*: The *salmonella* of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be negative.

3.6.10 Analytical sample procedure: A sample consisting of 454 g (16 ounces) of dehydrated product shall be selected at random from each lot.

3.6.11 Preparation of sample: Product shall be prepared according to the following method: In an appropriately sized blender container, blend the sample to uniformity in a minimum of time.

3.6.12 Analytical testing: When specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, analytical testing shall be in accordance with the following methods from the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International or as specified below:

	Test	Method
Chemical:	Salt	935.47
	Moisture	925.45A (at 60°C for 16 hours)
	Fat	922.06
Microbiological:	Standard Plate Count	Section 4.5 1/
	Yeast and Mold	Section 16.51 1/
	Coliform	Chapter 4 2/
	E. coli	MPN (Most Probable Number) 2/
	Salmonella	Chapter 5 2/
	Reduce Sulfite *Anaerobic Clostridium*	Chapter 37 2/

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1/ Compendium of Methods for the Microbiological Examination of Foods, Third Edition, 1992.
2/ Bacteriological Analytical Manual (BAM), Eighth Edition, 1995.

3.6.13 Test results: The test results for fat, salt, and moisture content shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. The test results for the standard plate count shall be reported to the nearest 2,500 per gram. The test results for yeast and mold shall be reported to the nearest 50 per gram. The test results for *coliform* shall be reported to the nearest 10 per gram. The test results for *E. coli* shall be reported to the nearest 0.001 per gram. The test results for *salmonella* shall be reported as negative or positive. The test results for reduced sulfite *anaerobic clostridium* shall be reported to the nearest CFU per gram. Any result not conforming to the finished product requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the dehydrated vegetable soup mix in the commercial marketplace. Delivered dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. *Purchaser shall specify 5.1 or 5.2.*

5.1 Product conformance. The dehydrated vegetable soup mix provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same dehydrated vegetable soup mix offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 USDA certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), USDA shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The dehydrated vegetable soup mix shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Types, classes, and optional ingredients required.
- When analytical testing is required.
- Product conformance (5.1) or USDA Certification (5.2) for dehydrated vegetable soup mix.

7.2 USDA certification contact.

For USDA certification, contact the Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

7.3 Sources of documents.

7.3.1 Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:

Copies of the BAM and Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

Copies of the Compendium of Methods for the Microbiological Examination of Foods, Third Edition, 1992, may be obtained from: **American Public Health Association, 1015 15th Street, NW, Washington, DC 20005-2605. Internet address: http:// www.apha.org.**

7.3.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P. O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit Card (MasterCard or VISA) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1803 **or on the Internet at: http:// www.nara.gov / fedreg.**

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Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

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